COMPREHENSIVE PROJECT PLAN

Corporate Learning Management System (LMS)

Prepared: August 2026

Version: 1.0 Final

1. Executive Summary & Project Objectives

This document outlines the comprehensive software project plan for the development and deployment of a cutting-edge **Corporate Learning Management System (LMS)**. As organizations scale, the need for standardized, trackable, and engaging employee training becomes paramount. This system is designed to facilitate corporate employee onboarding, compliance training, and continuous professional development through a centralized, cloud-hosted platform.

Primary Business Objectives

- **Reduce Onboarding Time:** Streamline the new hire training process to reduce time-to-productivity by 30%.
- **Ensure Compliance:** Automate regulatory and compliance training tracking to achieve 100% audit readiness.
- **Enhance Engagement:** Utilize interactive video content, gamification (badges/points), and quizzes to increase course completion rates.
- **Data-Driven Decisions:** Provide management with granular analytics regarding employee skill gaps and training efficacy.

The project will be executed using an Agile methodology paired with DevOps practices (CI/CD) to ensure rapid, iterative feature delivery and high system reliability.

2. Comprehensive Scope & Functional Requirements

The LMS is divided into three primary user modules, each tailored to specific roles within the corporate structure. This ensures a clean separation of concerns and optimized user experiences.

2.1 Learner Module (Employees)

The core experience for the end-user, focusing on intuitive discovery and consumption of educational content.

- **User Authentication & Profile:** Integration with Corporate Identity Providers via SAML 2.0/ OAuth2 for Single Sign-On (SSO). Personalized user profiles displaying enrolled courses, earned certificates, and skill tags.
- **Course Catalog & Search:** Advanced search functionality with filters (department, difficulty, duration). AI-driven course recommendations based on the user's role and previous completions.
- **Interactive Video Player:** Support for adaptive bitrate streaming, closed captions, and bookmarking. The player will pause automatically if the user switches tabs to ensure active participation.
- **Assessments & Quizzes:** Multiple-choice, true/false, and short-answer questions. Immediate feedback and scoring mechanisms.
- **Gamification & Certification:** Automated generation of PDF certificates upon course completion. Leaderboards and achievement badges to foster healthy competition among departments.

2.2 Content Creator Module (Trainers & HR)

Empowering educators and HR professionals to build and manage training curriculums without technical expertise.

- **Course Builder:** Drag-and-drop interface for structuring modules, lessons, and uploading multimedia (MP4, PDF, SCORM packages).
- **Quiz & Assessment Engine:** Tools to author complex quizzes, set passing thresholds, and define retake limits.
- **Cohort Management:** Ability to assign specific courses to groups of users (e.g., "Q3 New Hires" or "Engineering Team").
- **Learner Tracking:** Real-time dashboards showing user progress, quiz scores, and drop-off points within video content.

2.3 Admin & Compliance Module (System Administrators)

High-level system oversight, reporting, and technical configuration.

- **Role-Based Access Control (RBAC):** Granular permissions to define what learners, managers, trainers, and admins can view and edit.
- **Compliance Reporting:** Automated, scheduled reports (CSV/PDF) detailing compliance training status across the entire organization, crucial for regulatory audits.
- **System Configurations:** Management of email notification templates, API keys for third-party integrations (e.g., HRIS platforms like Workday or BambooHR), and branding (white-labeling).
- **Audit Logs:** Immutable tracking of all administrative actions for security and compliance purposes.

3. Non-Functional Requirements (NFRs)

To guarantee a seamless and secure experience, the LMS must adhere to strict non-functional criteria:

Category	Requirement Specification
Performance	Page load times must not exceed 2.5 seconds under normal load. Video buffering should initiate within 1 second on a standard broadband connection.
Scalability	The system must support up to 50,000 registered users and handle 5,000 concurrent video streams during peak corporate training windows.
Security	Data encryption at rest (AES-256) and in transit (TLS 1.3). Regular automated vulnerability scanning and adherence to OWASP Top 10 guidelines.
Availability	Targeting 99.9% uptime (approx. 8.7 hours of downtime per year). Implemented via multi-region cloud deployment.
Compliance	Strict adherence to GDPR, CCPA, and SOC 2 Type II data privacy and security standards.

4. System Architecture & Technology Stack

The application will utilize a modern, decoupled microservices architecture to ensure scalability and ease of maintenance.

Frontend (Client-Side)

- **Framework:** React.js (v18+) for building dynamic, responsive user interfaces.
- **Styling:** Tailwind CSS for rapid, consistent styling and theming.
- **State Management:** Redux Toolkit for managing complex global states (user sessions, course progress).

Backend (Server-Side)

- **Runtime & Framework:** Node.js with Express.js for building scalable, non-blocking RESTful APIs.
- **Authentication:** Passport.js integrated with corporate Identity Providers (Okta, Azure AD).
- **Media Processing:** FFmpeg (running on dedicated worker nodes) for transcoding uploaded videos into adaptive streaming formats (HLS).

Database & Caching

- **Primary Database:** PostgreSQL (Relational) for managing user accounts, RBAC, financial/license data, and complex reporting queries.
- **Document Store:** MongoDB (NoSQL) for storing flexible course content metadata, quiz structures, and JSON-heavy learning records.
- **Caching layer:** Redis for session management, API rate limiting, and caching frequently accessed course catalogs.

Cloud Infrastructure (AWS)

- **Compute:** Amazon EKS (Elastic Kubernetes Service) for orchestrating containerized microservices.
- **Storage:** Amazon S3 for storing raw and transcoded video files, PDFs, and user avatars.
- **Content Delivery:** Amazon CloudFront (CDN) to ensure low-latency video streaming globally.

5. Team Structure, Roles & Responsibilities

A cross-functional Agile team will be dedicated to this project, operating in 2-week sprints.

Role	Count	Key Responsibilities
Product Owner	1	Defines the product vision, manages the feature backlog, aligns requirements with business goals, and accepts sprint deliverables.
Scrum Master	1	Facilitates Agile ceremonies (Daily Standup, Planning, Retrospective), removes team blockers, and tracks sprint velocity.
UI/UX Designer	1	Creates wireframes, interactive prototypes (Figma), and conducts usability testing to ensure an intuitive learning experience.
Frontend Developers	3	Implement the UI designs using React, integrate REST APIs, build the custom video player, and ensure cross-browser compatibility.
Backend Developers	3	Design database schemas, build secure microservices, implement media transcoding logic, and integrate SSO.
QA/Test Engineers	2	Develop automated test scripts (Selenium/Cypress), perform load testing (JMeter), and conduct manual exploratory testing.
DevOps Engineer	1	Manages AWS infrastructure using Terraform, sets up CI/CD pipelines (GitHub Actions), and monitors system health (Datadog).

6. Detailed Agile Project Timeline (Sprint Plan)

The project is estimated to take 24 weeks, broken down into 12 two-week sprints. This timeline represents a phased approach from conception to deployment.

Phase 1: Foundation & Design (Sprints 1-3)

- **Sprint 1: Discovery & Architecture.** Finalize Software Requirement Specification (SRS). Establish cloud accounts (AWS). Design initial database schemas (PostgreSQL/MongoDB).
- **Sprint 2: UI/UX & Prototyping.** Complete wireframes for Learner Dashboard and Course Catalog. Setup frontend and backend code repositories with initial CI/CD pipelines.
- **Sprint 3: Core Authentication.** Implement SAML/OAuth2 Single Sign-On (SSO). Develop robust Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) backend logic.

Phase 2: Core Development (Sprints 4-8)

- **Sprint 4: Content Management (Backend).** Develop APIs for Course, Module, and Lesson creation. Setup AWS S3 buckets for secure media uploads.
- **Sprint 5: Media Processing.** Implement automated video transcoding pipeline using FFmpeg. Develop the frontend Content Creator interface for uploading courses.
- **Sprint 6: Learner Experience - Part 1.** Build the frontend Course Catalog, Search, and Filtering systems. Develop the personalized Learner Dashboard.
- **Sprint 7: Learner Experience - Part 2.** Integrate the custom video player with adaptive bitrate streaming. Implement progress tracking (saving video timestamps).
- **Sprint 8: Assessment Engine.** Develop the Quiz Builder for trainers. Build the quiz-taking interface for learners, including automated grading logic.

Phase 3: Advanced Features, Testing & Deployment (Sprints 9-12)

- **Sprint 9: Analytics & Reporting.** Develop the Admin Compliance Dashboard. Generate automated PDF certificates upon course completion.
- **Sprint 10: System Integration & QA.** End-to-end integration testing. HRIS integration (e.g., syncing users from BambooHR). Resolve priority 1 & 2 bugs.

- **Sprint 11: UAT & Load Testing.** User Acceptance Testing (UAT) with a pilot group of 100 employees. Execute load testing to simulate 5,000 concurrent users. Infrastructure optimization based on test results.
- **Sprint 12: Production Deployment & Handoff.** Final security penetration testing. Deployment to production environment. Delivery of Admin and Trainer documentation. Go-live.

7. Quality Assurance & Testing Strategy

Quality is built into the CI/CD pipeline. No code will be merged into the main branch without passing automated gates.

- **Unit Testing:** Developers will write unit tests using Jest (Frontend) and Mocha/Chai (Backend). Target code coverage is 80%.
- **Integration Testing:** Verifying the interaction between microservices and databases using Postman automation.
- **End-to-End (E2E) Testing:** Automated browser testing simulating real user journeys (e.g., login, search course, watch video, take quiz) using Cypress.
- **Performance Testing:** Simulating high-traffic events (e.g., company-wide mandatory compliance training rollout) using Apache JMeter to ensure AWS auto-scaling groups trigger correctly.
- **Security Testing:** Static Application Security Testing (SAST) integrated into GitHub Actions, followed by a manual penetration test by an external firm in Sprint 12.

8. Risk Management & Mitigation

Proactive risk management is essential for maintaining the timeline and budget. The following table identifies potential project risks and mitigation strategies.

Risk Description	Probability	Impact	Mitigation Strategy
Scope Creep: Stakeholders request additional features (e.g., live webinars) midway through development.	High	High	Strict Agile backlog management. New requests will be documented for "Phase 2" and prioritized by the Product Owner without altering current sprint scopes.
Video Streaming Latency: Users experience buffering or lag during high-definition video playback.	Medium	High	Utilize HLS adaptive bitrate streaming (automatically adjusting quality based on user bandwidth) and a robust global CDN (CloudFront).
Integration Failures: Difficulty integrating with legacy corporate Identity Providers for SSO.	Medium	Medium	Allocate dedicated time in Sprint 3 specifically for SSO PoC (Proof of Concept). Engage corporate IT security early in the project.
Low User Adoption: Employees find the platform difficult to navigate and avoid using it.	Low	High	Involve end-users early in the design phase via surveys and prototypes. Conduct thorough UAT in Sprint 11 and refine UI based on feedback.
Cloud Infrastructure Cost Overruns: Video storage and transcoding costs exceed budget.	Medium	Medium	Implement strict lifecycle policies on S3 (archiving old videos to Glacier). Monitor AWS billing daily and set up anomaly alerts.

9. Deployment, Maintenance & Future Roadmap

Deployment Strategy

The system will use a **Blue-Green deployment strategy**. This involves maintaining two identical production environments. The new release is deployed to the idle environment, tested, and then traffic is routed to it. This ensures zero-downtime deployments and allows for instantaneous rollbacks if critical issues are detected.

Post-Launch Support & Maintenance

- **Hypercare Period:** For the first 30 days post-launch, the entire development team will be on standby for immediate bug resolution and user support.
- **Ongoing Maintenance:** Transition to a dedicated Support Team (Level 2 & Level 3). Routine security patching (OS and dependencies) will occur monthly.
- **Monitoring:** Continuous monitoring using Datadog (application performance) and AWS CloudWatch (infrastructure metrics). Alerts configured for high CPU usage or elevated API error rates.

Future Roadmap (Phase 2)

To ensure the LMS evolves with the organization, the following features are slated for Phase 2 (post-launch):

- **Live Virtual Classrooms:** Integration with Zoom or Microsoft Teams APIs for instructor-led live training directly within the LMS.
- **Social Learning:** Discussion forums and peer-to-peer messaging within specific courses to encourage collaborative learning.
- **Mobile Application:** Development of native iOS and Android applications utilizing React Native for offline viewing of downloaded courses.
- **Advanced AI Analytics:** Machine learning algorithms to predict employee churn based on training engagement and to automatically suggest personalized career path curriculums.

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